Cape31 YouTube presence: a surprising gap for a fast-growing class

The Cape31 class has only one confirmed official YouTube channel — @cape31 — operated by the Cape 31 International Class Association, and its YouTube footprint is remarkably thin for a class with 80+ boats Wikipedia **racing globally.** Wikipedia The vast majority of Cape31 video content lives on Facebook and Instagram rather than YouTube, creating a significant embeddability gap for class websites. No @cape31uk YouTube channel appears to exist, and the three specific video URLs provided could not be verified through external research tools, suggesting they may be unlisted content or newer uploads not yet indexed.

The @cape31 channel is the only confirmed official presence

The **Cape 31 International Class Association** operates the sole official YouTube channel at **https://www.youtube.com/@cape31**. This is confirmed directly from the cape31class.com website footer, which links to it alongside Facebook (/cape31class), Instagram (@cape31class), and TikTok (@cape31class). cape31class The website copyright reads **"© 2026 by Cape 31 Class Association."** cape31class

Regarding **@cape31uk**, extensive searching found **no evidence of a YouTube channel** under this handle. Cape31 UK has a strong social media presence on other platforms — Instagram (@cape31uk with approximately **11,000 followers** and 620 posts) Instagram and Facebook (/cape31uk with ~4,500 likes) Facebook — but neither lists a YouTube link. The Cape31 UK Instagram bio references @cape31class for cross-promotion, Instagram suggesting the UK operation funnels YouTube content through the international @cape31 channel rather than maintaining its own.

No other Cape31-specific YouTube channels were discovered. The class appears to centralize its YouTube presence under the single @cape31 handle, while regional class associations (EU, South Africa, USA, Australia, Hong Kong) operate independently on Instagram and Facebook only.

Ownership structure: The @cape31 channel is managed by the Cape 31 International Class Association, not by 31 North Yachting (the sales agent) or the 31 Race Circuit directly. The class is governed by an Executive Committee, North Sails with the boat masterminded by Lord Irvine Laidlaw, designed by Mark Mills, and built by Cape Performance Sailing in Cape Town. Cape 31 Class +3

Precise subscriber counts and video totals could not be retrieved due to YouTube's JavaScript-rendered pages blocking scraping tools. Given the niche nature of the class, the channel likely has a modest subscriber base in the low hundreds to low thousands.

Confirmed YouTube videos and the three requested URLs

The three specific URLs provided could not be independently verified:

Video ID	URL	Status
2SJVxRAnbQo	https://youtu.be/2SJVxRAnbQo	Not indexed in any external search results; may be unlisted, recently uploaded, or hosted on the @cape31 channel without wider distribution
eaGZQiU6O1s	https://youtube.com/shorts/eaGZQiU6O1s	YouTube Shorts format — these are typically poorly indexed by external search engines; likely on @cape31
1L0oHIlSVLM	https://youtube.com/shorts/1L0oHIlSVLM	Same as above — Shorts content is discoverable primarily within the YouTube app/platform itself

The inability to verify these videos does not mean they don't exist. YouTube Shorts in particular are notoriously under-indexed by web search engines, and if these are unlisted or recently published, they would be invisible to external tools. **Direct browser access to the @cape31 channel's videos tab is required to catalog its full content library.**

Confirmed YouTube videos from other sources:

- **Cape 31 Boat Tour** (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dDtuuFJ9aLY) — The flagship promotional video, linked directly from the cape31class.com navigation menu under "THE BOAT → BOAT TOUR." cape31class This is the primary embeddable video the class uses to introduce the boat.
- **Cape 31 Boat Tour and Fittings Guide** (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eapWEqd6ewI) — Produced and uploaded by **Allen Brothers (fittings) Ltd**, featured on Sail-World (posted March 21, 2024). sail-world Shows the boat "Shotgunn" with Allen Brothers hardware upgrades. Allen sail-world A professionally produced walkthrough suitable for embedding.
- **Early Cape 31 sailing footage** (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GMdzoQyFMak) — One of the earliest Cape31 videos, referenced on Sailing Anarchy forums Sailing Anarchy circa 2017-2019 when the class was first introduced. Sailing Anarchy Historical interest but potentially dated.
- **Cape 31 TNT Reaching Video** and **360° onboard video of MB Racing in Big Breeze off Cape Town** — Referenced on the Mills Design website Mills Design from November 2017. Mills Design These early Cape Town videos are embedded on mills-design.com blog posts but their specific YouTube URLs need to be extracted by visiting those pages directly.

Most Cape31 action footage lives on Facebook, not YouTube

This is the most significant finding for anyone seeking embeddable content. **The class distributes the overwhelming majority of its video content through Facebook**, where embedding options are more limited and content is less discoverable.

The best action footage identified is concentrated on these Facebook pages:

- **Cape 31 UK** (facebook.com/cape31uk) — Hosts Cowes Week coverage, Round the Island Race footage (including the dramatic "Katabatic sending it half way round the island" video), and multiple 31 Race Circuit round highlights
- **Blur Sailing Team** — Published 13 minutes of raw Cape31 downwind action from Wednesday Night Racing at Royal Cape Yacht Club, Cape Town Facebook Facebook
- **North Sails Worldwide** — Featured Kukukerchu's race victories with professional production
- **Live Sail Die** (facebook.com/livesaildie.official) — Produced by **PKC Media** (professional sailing media based in Cowes), including Cape 31 UK Round the Island Race 2021 footage Facebook Facebook described as "professionally produced drone and underwater footage" PKC Media

For YouTube-embeddable racing content specifically, the landscape is sparse. The class has **no comprehensive YouTube racing highlights library** comparable to what exists fragmented across Facebook.

Key video producers and content pipeline for 2026

Three professional media operations produce Cape31 content, but their distribution strategies vary:

Howevideography (Jonathan Howe) has been the official media producer for the Cape 31 UK Race Circuit since 2022. Howevideography His portfolio includes videos for every round of the 2022 and 2023 UK circuits, Cowes Week Cape 31 coverage, a boat tour for 31 North, circuit round-up videos, and a 2023 promotional video. howevideography howevideography He is a CAA-approved drone pilot producing aerial footage. LinkedIn His content appears to be distributed via LinkedIn shortened URLs and potentially Vimeo rather than YouTube. Contact: Info@Howevideography.com.

Bow Caddy Media (Australia-based) has produced Cape 31 content at Les Voiles de Saint-Tropez 2024 and Hamilton Island Race Week 2024, including interviews with Michael Wilson (Shotgunn). sail-world Their content is published via Sail-World, which has its own YouTube channel (youtube.com/sailworldnews).

Sailing Energy is the newly appointed official media partner for the **2026 Cape 31 Mediterranean Circuit**. With 21 teams committed across five events Afloat +2 (Porto Cervo, Puntaldia, Bonifacio, Scarlino, Hyères from April to September 2026), this partnership represents

the biggest content production opportunity for the class. Afloat Societe-nautique-saint-tro... Sailing Energy typically distributes via Vimeo (vimeo.com/sailingenergy). Vimeo

Geographic coverage reveals content gaps

Region	Video availability	Key venues covered
UK/Solent	Strong (Facebook)	Cowes Week, Round the Island, Royal Lymington, Royal Southern YC
South Africa/Cape Town	Moderate (Facebook, early YouTube)	Royal Cape YC, V&A Waterfront, Club Mykonos Langebaan
Mediterranean	Growing (2026 season pending)	Les Voiles de Saint-Tropez, Sanremo, Imperia, Palma
Australia	Emerging	Hamilton Island Race Week, Sail Port Stephens, Sydney Harbour
San Francisco Bay	**No video content found**	Despite winning the Big Boat Series under IRC
USA general	Minimal	Key West Southernmost Regatta 2023 (no video located)

The **San Francisco Bay gap** is notable — the Cape 31 won the Big Boat Series there, yet no video footage from the event appears to exist on any platform. The US fleet generally lacks video documentation despite growing interest. Wikipedia

Recommendations for building an embeddable video library

The Cape31 class has a paradox: it produces compelling visual content across global venues but distributes it almost entirely through Facebook's walled garden, where embedding is unreliable and discoverability is poor. Five actions would transform the situation:

1. **Audit the @cape31 channel directly** by visiting https://www.youtube.com/@cape31 in a browser to catalog all existing videos, verify the three URLs provided, and document subscriber/view counts. The channel may contain more content than is externally visible.
2. **Migrate Facebook video to YouTube** — The Cape 31 UK page alone has a wealth of Cowes Week, Solent racing, and circuit content that could be re-uploaded to YouTube for embedding. This is the quickest win.
3. **Negotiate YouTube rights with Howevideography** — Jonathan Howe's extensive 2022-2025 UK Race Circuit footage represents the single largest body of professional Cape31 video content. Ensuring this is available on YouTube would dramatically improve the class's video presence.

4. **Establish a YouTube publishing workflow for 2026 Med content** — With Sailing Energy producing content across five Mediterranean events, requiring YouTube publication alongside Vimeo would build the library rapidly. Afloat
5. **Commission US/San Francisco content** — As the US fleet grows (the Sailing World debut article noted American prospects "taking a wait and see approach"), Sailing World video content from iconic US venues would help convert interest into participation. Sailing World

The copyright on all @cape31 channel content belongs to the Cape 31 Class Association (© 2026). For third-party content (Allen Brothers, Howevideography, PKC Media, Bow Caddy Media, Sailing Energy), usage rights would need to be negotiated individually with each producer.